Red

Strength · passion · support

A red rose invites you closer, a red traffic light stops you. One colour and so many different messages. It can open up the theme of passion, determination and how much space you allow yourself. Sometimes you only want it in a painting, at other times a small detail in your hair or a private secret under your clothes is enough.

This page does not tell you what red means. **It shows it to you from several sides**. How it is mixed, how it is painted with, where its strength comes from, how it is read in different cultures and **what it can awaken in us**.

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How to mix the colour and its shades

For painting, the simplest way to get red is to take it from the tube. In an ordinary painter's set it is one of the primary colours, which is why it cannot be mixed from other colours. But different reds **do not start in the same place**. One leans towards orange, another towards pink and violet. The ratios are approximate and every brand behaves a little differently, so try them out on paper first.

What to prepare

Basic red
The centre of the family from which everything else unfolds.

Cooler crimson
Leans towards raspberry and violet.

Warmer scarlet
Leans towards orange, tomato and poppy red.

Purple, or magenta
A strong pinkish red that adds a cool, raspberry tinge.

Yellow
Pushes towards orange tones.

Ultramarine blue
Deepens the mix towards wine and violet.

Green
Its counterpart on the colour wheel; it mutes.

Earthy brown
Helps you look for brick and earthy reds.

White
Lightens and often shifts towards pink.

How can you recognise it without technical names?

A warmer scarlet can remind you of a tomato or a wild poppy. A cooler crimson comes close to raspberries or a pinkish red. Names on tubes differ between makers, so put **small samples** side by side and **add white** to part of them. The tint will then be easier to see.

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What the additions do



White

Lightens and often shifts towards pink. Add it a little at a time.





Yellow

Leads towards orange tones.





Blue

Can deepen the mix towards wine or violet.





Green

A suitable green mutes; a large amount can create a brownish mix.





Earthy brown

Helps you look for brick and earthy reds.





Black

Try it a little at a time; it can darken the mix and dirty it. For darkening, brown or a little dark blue often works better.



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Ten reds to try

One part is an equal amount of paint. The ratios are our **approximate** starting points for experiments. The samples on screen are not the measured result of a recipe. Mix small amounts first and let them dry.

Soft pink

□ □ □ □ + ■

4 parts white + gradually about 1 part red. A strong red may need much more white.

Salmon

□ □ □ + ■ + ■

3 parts white + 1 part warmer red + a trace of yellow. Yellow pushes it towards orange; add it carefully.

Coral

■ ■ ■ + □ + ■

3 parts warmer red + 1 part white + a small dot of yellow. Compare it with salmon; less white means a more saturated impression.

Brick

■ ■ ■ + ■ + ■

3 parts red + a small amount of yellow and earthy brown. Add the brown by the tip of the brush so the mix does not lose its red character.

Terracotta

■ ■ + □ + ■

2 parts warmer red + 1 part white + a little earthy brown; yellow as needed. Look for the tone of fired clay, not one obligatory colour.

Raspberry

■ ■ + ■

2 parts crimson red + 1 part magenta; a little white if you like. If you already have a cool red, you may need less magenta.

Wine

■ ■ ■ + ■ + ■

3 parts crimson + a trace of ultramarine and, if needed, a little brown. Blue can stain strongly; try it in a separate portion.

Burgundy

■ ■ ■ + ■ + ■

3 parts red + ultramarine and brown added by the tip of the brush. The names wine and burgundy overlap; go by the actual sample.

Muted pink

□ □ □ □ + ■ + ■

4 parts white + 1 part red + a very small trace of a suitable green. Green can quickly mute the mix to grey or brown.

Earthy red

■ ■ + ■

2 parts red + 1 part earthy brown; white as needed. Every brown shifts the mix elsewhere; write down the name of the tube.

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Rainbow – the chakra system

In the usual order of seven colours red comes first; in the main arc of the rainbow you find it on the outer edge next to orange. In the rainbow map of chakras it is the first one and belongs to the root chakra. You can imagine it as a place for **safety**, **support** and the feeling of **“I have my place”**.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions



Red · root

Safety, support, presence. Ask yourself. Do I have something to lean on? What gives me a sense of safety right now?



Orange · sacral

Experiencing, pleasure, creating. Ask yourself. What does me good? Where do I allow myself joy?



Yellow · solar plexus

Self-worth, will. Ask yourself. What do I want? Where do I need to stand up for myself?



Green · heart

Closeness, relationships. Ask yourself. How am I with myself? Whom do I let close?



Blue · throat

Voice, expression. Ask yourself. What do I need to say? What do I no longer want to swallow?



Indigo · third eye

Inner vision, intuition. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?



Violet · crown

Meaning, transcendence, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me meaning? What do I feel connected to?

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Muladhara, the root chakra

Chakras come from the Indian yoga and tantric tradition. The root chakra is called **Muladhara** (mula means root, adhara support). It is traditionally placed at the **base of the spine** and the pelvic floor. It is associated with the element earth, the sound syllable **LAM** and a red lotus with four petals.

Its theme is **safety**, **home**, **the body** and the feeling of **"I am allowed to be here"**. For women this is often translated into questions. Do I have something to lean on? Can I rest? Do I allow myself to say no? Can I leave something to others too? If chakras mean nothing to you, take it as an image of a firm foundation. **Something you stand on, even when you cannot see it.**

When the chakra is open. In your body you feel **at home**, you know what you need, you can rest and **say no** without writing a three-page explanation. Support is not the same as control. **The roots hold, the branches move.**

When the chakra is closed. Traditional descriptions mention **insecurity**, tiredness and fear about basic things. Housing, money, loved ones or the future. It is hard to say no and even harder to rest. **A closed chakra does not mean a bad one.** Sometimes you are simply going through a period when you have little support.

How to add red when you lack support

- **Wear it**
  Red is often recommended on the lower half of the body. Socks, shoes, trousers or underwear. Nobody needs to see it. It is enough that you know.
- **Put it in your home**
  A red seat cushion, blanket or candle. Rather a small detail than a red room from floor to ceiling.
- **Eat it**
  Beetroot, red lentils, strawberries or pomegranate. In yoga texts this is symbolism, not a diet prescribed by a chakra.
- **Get creating**
  Big red strokes, even with your whole arm. With no goal and no question about whether it is "pretty".
- **Head out into nature**
  Walking barefoot, sitting on a stone, leaning against a tree. The main theme is the same. Feeling the ground under your feet.
- **Put it into your day**
  A red bookmark, a candle or a lipstick that you put on just for yourself. A little certainty on an ordinary day.

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When and how to take red away when there is too much certainty

When you are restless, upset or constantly on alert, another strong red **may not be what you long for**. Some descriptions speak of an “overloaded” root chakra, where the need for certainty takes up almost the whole table. This is only a symbolic image. A feeling of insecurity often has to do with what is **really happening**, such as losing a job, a break-up or long-term strain. Then **real support** matters more than a label.

- **Brick instead of sharp**
  Brick, rusty or brownish red tends to be calmer than a sharp one.
- **Further from the face**
  Move red to your socks, say, instead of a scarf.
- **Add brown**
  Brown, ochre, beige, wood, stone or plants.
- **A calmer evening**
  Take away strong red surfaces, choose calmer light, slow your breath or spend a while in nature.

This is inspiration from tradition, not treatment. Try gently and notice how you actually feel afterwards.

Picture it with an example

You start with red, but you need to add green. You can give it the meaning of closeness that you also want to feel alongside your own support. You add blue. Perhaps you want to allow yourself to say what you need so that you feel safe.

You choose the meaning; the colour you add does not diagnose your state.

You do not have to pick just one side of yourself. You may need safety, closeness and courage all at once. In a painting there can be room for all of them side by side, and they need not form a tidy rainbow.

Next to red, other colours can feel calmer or sharper. Green softens it, blue cools it and yellow brightens it. **These are possibilities of a personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a combination of colours.

How to use this map

It is a way to sort out the themes you are living through. Do you add red because you lack support and the drive to go for it? Or do you take it away because your body is already humming enough? **You choose the meaning.** Both options can be fine.

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Free painting – intuition

When we paint freely, with no goal and no effort to make something "correct", **red** often shows up by itself. **The hand reaches for it before the brain has time to call a meeting.** And that is exactly what is **interesting** about it. Sometimes we know exactly **why**, at other times not at all. **Both are fine.**

What can hide behind a red stroke

The same red line on paper can mean **something completely different** depending on what is going on in us. Sometimes it is **a scream, at other times an embrace**, sometimes pure joy in the colour. That is why it **makes no sense** to read a painting as a test with **one right answer**.

Anger that we would never say out loud.

The stroke tends to be sharp, fast and strong, sometimes even tearing the paper.

Longing for closeness

for touch, for someone to notice us.

The stroke tends to be flowing, circular and softer.

Zest for life and energy.

Large areas, a lot of paint and joy in the movement of the hand.

Fear or tension.

Small, tightly drawn spots, hard outlines, red kept at the edge of the paper.

Courage or defiance.

Red that plants itself in the middle and refuses to be overpowered.

Sadness or loss.

Red that we choose because no other colour is strong enough.

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Red in a painting. Can it express what is going on inside?

Yes, it **can** – but it **does not have to**. When you paint, you sometimes reach for a colour before you can name what you feel. Red can then give form to rage, pain, defiance, desire or the simple feeling of "there is so much in me".

It can just as well belong to joy and the wish to live again. It gains **meaning** only in connection with **your experience**. **The colour itself does not know what happened to you**. You do – or you will work it out in time.

Art therapy also works with the idea that a picture can express something for which words are hard to find. What matters is not a single patch of colour but **the whole picture** and how it came to be. Your situation, memories, the movement of your hand and your feelings while painting.

A predominance of red alone **is not enough for a verdict** of "this is anger". Maybe you were angry. Maybe you wanted to cover a previous layer. And maybe you simply enjoyed that red so much that pastel had no chance that day.

I want it on the canvas, but I don't dare put it on myself

A red painting and a red dress may ask two completely different things of you. On **canvas** you give **space to an experience**. In clothing you may feel you are putting yourself on show. That is why a large red area in a painting can attract you while the thought of walking among people in a red coat frightens you.

Perhaps you need to express a strength you have held inside for a long time, but you do not yet want to stand out in front of others. **The canvas can be a safe place** where you allow yourself to express in your own way.

This is one possible connection; sometimes the explanation is much simpler – a different taste for pictures and for a wardrobe. And even after ten red paintings **you do not have to start wearing a red dress**. **No obligation comes out of it**.

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When red takes over the space

Let red take as much room **as you want**. You do not have to soften it right away, balance it or defend it. Later you can notice what is going on in you. Relief, joy, tiredness, or on the contrary more tension.

Not even relief automatically proves a specific meaning of the colour, and after painting you do not have to feel reborn. If painting starts to **wind you up** instead, feel free to **put the colours aside**. **A pause is part of the work too**.

Three things worth noticing

QUANTITY

A small flash, or the whole surface?

A tiny red mark can be the centre of the whole painting for you. A large area can feel strong, lively and free, or it can become too loud. A large red area is not proof of great anger, and a small mark does not mean you do not dare to claim your strength.

SATURATION

Saturated, or gentle?

Pure red has the look of a ripe cherry or a poppy flower. With white it turns pink or coral, with brown or ochre it comes close to brick and clay. If a wave of relief washes over you after adding white, that very change is interesting. Perhaps a less urgent look suits you today. You do not have to draw a conclusion about your whole personality from it.

THICKNESS

What does it feel like under your hands?

Thick paint you can push, spread and leave a mark in. Thin paint flows and runs and may surprise you with a direction you had not planned. Sometimes you enjoy the substance and resistance, at other times the chance to let go of control and watch what happens. It is not a test of courage. A careful, thin stroke can be exactly your language for today.

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What to take from the picture

It is not about whether a red stroke looks “right”. What matters more is what you feel while making it, what situation you are in and what is going on in your life right now. Two almost identical pictures can have a completely different story. One was made after an argument, the other after a long time alone. That is why you will not find a **dictionary** here of the “red = anger” kind, but **questions**. **Life will not fit into a single colour chart anyway**.

A picture can speak even after time

Perhaps after a while you will notice that you kept returning to red in a period when you lacked **support**, **courage** or the wish to be seen. Perhaps you will link it with a completely **different experience**. In self-reflective work inspired by art therapy, a picture can serve as a trace of **your own experience** and a chance to look back.

Answers often do not come right away

Sometimes you look at a picture and it tells you nothing at all. Just colour, strokes, done. And a week, a month or a year later it suddenly comes: “Aha, this is what I was carrying in me back then.” That is fine. **The picture is not going anywhere**. **You do not have to** squeeze an **answer** out of it with a still-wet brush.

Neither is wrong and neither is right. Anger, longing, fear and zest for life all belong to you, and red can **carry everything**.

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Associations and stories

Our associations

Associations are connections that form between us and a colour almost by themselves. We are not born with a ready list of “red = this”, and yet some meanings repeat surprisingly often. They are usually made up of three layers. **From the body**, **from culture** and from **what we have lived ourselves**.

From the body

Red is the colour of **blood**, **fire** and **a flushed face**. Our body knows it before we start to analyse it. We blush with shame, anger, joy and excitement, and our heart may start to beat faster. That is why life, warmth and energy are easily linked with it – but so is pain. **One colour, two very different sides of the same coin**.

From culture

The heart on a Valentine's card is usually red. So is the “stop” sign. In China red is traditionally the colour of luck and celebration. One single colour thus manages **love**, **prohibition** and **festivity**. **What we read in it also depends on where and in what we grew up**.

From what you have lived

Mum's red lips, the red pencil at school, a first red dress or the car in which something happened that is never forgotten. These are associations with **their own signature**. **Two women can look at exactly the same red** and one feels strength, the other tension. The colour is the same. **The story is not**.

When you know where your associations come from, it is easier to tell what “red” actually is and what is your own story about it.

A question for you

“What do you connect red with first?”

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Stories

Blood and blushing

Red is the colour of **blood**, **life** and **warmth**. The body knows it before we name it. We blush with shame, anger, embarrassment and excitement, our cheeks burn and our heart speeds up. To blush means that something is going on in us and that it shows.

A red rag to a bull

The saying “it is like a red rag to a bull for me” is known to all of us. **Only the bull does not know about it**. By all accounts it does not perceive red the way we do and will charge at a cloth of any other colour as well. What throws it off is **movement**, **not colour**. The red cloth is tradition and theatre for the audience. It is also often said to hide the blood, but that is not firmly documented.

So the saying is more about us than about the bull. **Red sets something off in us** and we conveniently blame the colour.

Traffic lights and red

Of all visible colours red has **the longest wavelength**. It scatters least in air, fog and smoke, so **it can be seen from the farthest away**. That is why the railways already used it in the 19th century as the “stop” signal.

Red meant danger back then anyway, so it is hard to say what decided more. Optics, or the old link with blood and fire. Red **stops** us and **heats us up** at the same time. Stop, something important is happening here.

Red and eroticism

Why is red light associated with brothels? It is not known exactly. The term “red light district” appears in the American press at the end of the 19th century and there are several explanations. Railwaymen with lanterns, a saloon called Red Light in Dodge City and others.

None of them is confirmed. All that is certain is that the link between red and **physicality**, **desire** and **the forbidden** is old and common in many cultures.

So red is probably not a magic wand. It is more of a **story** we tell about it, and that story is strong.

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Emotions and feelings

The same red can awaken **fear** in one of us and **desire** in another – sometimes even both in one day.

Red can awaken energy, courage, joy, passion and desire, but also rage, tension, shame, envy or a feeling of threat. It is not that the colour has **one fixed effect**. We respond to it with **our body, experience, culture and the situation** in which we meet it.

Emotions

Quick, strong reactions that can appear in an instant.

Fear and threat

Red can trigger **alertness**, **tension** or the need to **stop**. The body seems to say. **Careful, something is going on here**.

And why?

It is linked with **blood**, **warning**, **traffic lights**, **prohibition** and **error**. We have learned these meanings culturally too. For some people red therefore draws attention pleasantly, while for others it quickly opens up **a feeling of threat**.

Ask yourself

"When does red feel like a warning or a prohibition to me?"

Anger and defiance

It can bring out **rage**, **resistance**, **determination** and **the urge to say no**. Sometimes it is pure anger, at other times **energy that finally defends a boundary**.

And why?

In strong agitation the body is flushed with blood, the pulse speeds up and the face may turn red. Red has also long been used as a colour of **protest, struggle and strength**. That is why it can work as a visual **"enough"**.

Try asking yourself

"What is hiding under my anger – tiredness, pain, helplessness, or a sense of injustice?"

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Joy and excitement

Red can bring **a spark**, **zest for life**, **anticipation** and **a kick-start**. It is that feeling when something is finally happening.

And why?

It is striking, quickly catches attention and recalls **fire, warmth and movement**. The brain therefore easily reads it as something **alive and active**. In a good mood it can really "kick us into gear".

If I asked you now

"When does red charge you up, and when does it stop being fun?"

Desire and sexual arousal

It can evoke **attraction**, **desire**, **passion** and **physical arousal** – but just as easily **shame** or **embarrassment**.

And why?

With arousal the body changes. The pulse quickens, the skin flushes and the lips and cheeks may turn red. On top of that came cultural images of red lips, dresses, roses and lingerie. Red thus became a strong **shorthand for eroticism and attraction**.

Ask yourself

"Does red feel sexy, cheeky, flirtatious, or something else entirely?"

Feelings and experience

Less immediate than emotions. They say more about how we feel in red with ourselves and among people.

Being seen

Red can bring **confidence** and **joy in attention**, but also **embarrassment**, **shame** or a feeling of **"I am too much"**.

And why?

Red draws the eye faster than many muted colours. If we have learned to be inconspicuous, this may be exactly what feels unpleasant. It is not necessarily the colour that bothers us – **what bothers us is the feeling that we are suddenly visible**.

A question for you

"Do you enjoy it when someone turns to look at you, or does it rather unsettle you?"

Closeness and love

Red can feel like **warmth**, **an embrace**, **tenderness** and **closeness**. The same colour can also open **an old pain** or **a wound**.

And why?

For centuries we have linked it with the heart, roses, love and celebrations of relationships. That is why it can bring up not only lovely memories but also those in which **closeness was tied to disappointment**.

If I asked you now

"Do you connect red with love and romance? Or rather with pain?"

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Strength and courage

In red we can feel **firmer**, **more decisive** and **readier to act**. At other times it can feel like **pressure**. You must be strong, you must cope with something.

And why?

Red recalls fire, blood in the veins and a quickened pulse – that is, a state in which the body is **ready for action**. That is why we easily link it with **strength**, **performance** and **courage**.

Ask yourself

"What would I allow myself in red that I do not allow myself otherwise?"

Sensuality and relationship to the body

Sometimes red works quite quietly. Lipstick, underwear, a scarf or a detail **that mainly we ourselves know about**. It can bring a feeling of **femininity**, **sensuality** and **"this is mine"**.

And why?

It is not a magical property of the colour. Red works as a **personal signal** and a **cultural symbol**. When we link it with the body, femininity or attraction, it can remind us of **our own physicality** without a single outside glance.

A question for you

"Do you have something red that you wear only for yourself?"

My red is not the same as your red

A colour itself **experiences nothing. We experience it.** When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), **the experience** sticks to it. The colour then becomes **a shortcut**. One glimpse is enough and the body knows whether it can relax or should pull back. That is why **your own reaction** always matters more than a universal dictionary of colours.

- **Red lipstick**
  For one woman it is mum and festive moments, for another something that was not allowed.
- **Red pencil**
  For one it is praise, for another a crossing-out and shame at school.
- **Rose**
  Love and romance, or an obligatory bouquet and embarrassment.
- **Siren and flashing lights**
  A feeling that help is coming, or a moment when your stomach clenches.
- **Red mug from home**
  Warmth and a morning at the table, or a home you wanted to get away from.

Why does it attract me even though I am actually afraid of it?

Perhaps it does not express how you feel. Perhaps you are drawn to what **you lack**. After a long period when you held back, red can remind you that you may take up space, have appetite and be seen. It can also be attractive because it gives you a feeling of strength, even if you cannot yet carry all of it. Try it first in a small detail and watch whether it gives you courage or rather unsettles you.

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Why does it seem unpleasant to me, on the contrary?

A strong red is **too loud** for you. It reminds you of **prohibition**, **shouting** or an environment where you were far too exposed. If you have long **had to endure pressure**, its urgency may remind you of a role you no longer want to play. Aversion to red does not have to mean you reject strength or passion. Maybe you are only rejecting another **duty to be on guard all the time**. Try to tell whether all red bothers you or only a certain form of it. Burgundy can be beautiful even if you do not want a bright red wall even in a photograph.

When to add it and when to take it away

Add it where it pleases you and opens something pleasant. Take it away when you catch yourself **looking away from it**, everything seems too strong or you finally want fewer stimuli. Notice the changes. **Brick red does me good**, bright scarlet disturbs me. In winter it draws me more than in summer. In a painting I want it big, in clothes I do not yet feel at ease in it. These are your concrete experiences. They do not have to fit into one answer, **“I like red”**.

If I asked you now

Has my relationship with red changed with age?

What does red in a room awaken in you? Try to remember whether you have seen it somewhere in someone's room. How did you feel there?

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Red in cultures and traditions

Red does not have the same **meaning** everywhere. In some places it is the colour of luck and celebration, elsewhere of protection, faith, physicality or strength. And then there are traditional systems that work with red in yet another way – as an element, a symbol or a tool for balance.

This chapter therefore shows **two levels**. What red means in different cultures and how traditional systems work with it.

Red in different cultures

China

In China red is the colour of **luck**, **joy**, **prosperity** and **celebration**. That is why you will see it at weddings, at Chinese New Year and at important family events.

For centuries red has been linked with a good omen and wishes of success. At New Year red envelopes with money – hong bao – are given, and lanterns and red inscriptions with wishes for the coming year are hung up.

Red also plays a prominent role at weddings, where it symbolises joy, happiness and a new beginning. Interestingly, while white tends to be the wedding colour here, in traditional Chinese symbolism **white** is on the contrary associated more with **mourning and funerals**.

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India

In many parts of India red is strongly linked with **weddings**, **marriage**, **femininity** and **an auspicious beginning**. That is why traditional wedding garments are often red, crimson or red and gold.

In Hindu symbolism red is linked with **life force**, **fertility**, **love** and the energy of **shakti** – the feminine principle of power and creative energy.

Married women may also wear sindoor, a red powder applied in the parting of the hair. The red powder kumkum is used in religious ceremonies too and may be applied to the forehead as a sign of blessing, respect or an auspicious event.

In India red is therefore often much more than just "the colour of passion". It can mean **life**, **protection**, **union**, **feminine strength** and **sacredness**.

And as elsewhere, India is **not one tradition** in one package – meanings and customs differ by region, religion and family.

Russia

Here red is interesting already in the language itself. The Russian word krasny now means "red", but in older Russian it also meant "**beautiful**".

This is also where the name of Red Square in Moscow is explained from – it was originally not meant to be "red" in a political sense, but rather a beautiful or magnificent square.

Language sometimes keeps older layers of meaning far longer than our idea of a colour. Here **beauty and red** once overlapped.

Later, of course, red in Russia also gained a strong political layer, but that came much later.

It is a nice example of how **one colour** can carry completely **different stories** in different times.

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Christianity

In the Christian tradition red is the colour of **fire**, **blood**, **sacrifice** and strong **faith**.

In the liturgy it is used, for example, at Pentecost, where it recalls the fire of the Holy Spirit. Red also appears at feasts of martyrs, where it refers to blood and sacrifice.

Cardinals wear red robes as a symbol of readiness to bear their faith even at the cost of their own blood.

Red here stands between two strong images. **Fire and blood**. Fire can mean **zeal**, **strength** and **spiritual energy**. Blood means **life**, **sacrifice** and a willingness to really carry something.

That is why in a Christian setting red is both **festive** and **serious**. It is not a gentle background colour. **It always says that something important is happening**.

Red in traditional systems

Each tradition looks at red **a little differently**, but all of them take it seriously. It is an old symbolic language and inspiration, not a guide to healing.

Traditional Chinese medicine

Traditional Chinese medicine works with five elements – wood, fire, earth, metal and water. Red belongs to **fire**. It is linked with summer, the south, the bitter taste, joy and the sphere of the heart.

The “heart” here is not just a pump. In the traditional view it is also linked with **shen**, a concept translated roughly as **mind**, **spirit** or **consciousness**. It covers joy, sleep and contact with others. When, according to this teaching, there is too much fire, restlessness, overheating and poor sleep are described. When there is too little, they speak of cold and tiredness. Wood feeds fire like logs in a stove, and from the ashes comes earth.

> Fire is meant to warm you. It is not meant to set your living room on fire.

What you can take from it. In this system red is **the colour of fire**, that is, of warmth, joy and connection with people. **You do not have to** analyse the state of your heart with every red jumper. A simple question is enough. **How much warmth, joy and closeness do I have in my life right now?** And how much is already heat, pressure and rush?

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Ask yourself

“Where does the fire burn pleasantly in my life – and where is it already too hot?”

A spark that sweeps others along

In traditional images fire is linked with a person who **can inspire others**. You get an idea, you light up, and ten minutes later there is a WhatsApp group and someone is looking for an extension cord. That is the lovely side of fire. But it has the same speed in the other direction too. You say “sure” before you have even looked at your calendar. In the image of fire there is a difference between “I burn for something” and “everything burns me”. **You do not have to** brake your energy, it just does not need to run at maximum revs all the time.

I love red. Why?

Perhaps you are drawn to its decisiveness, or you feel more like yourself in a red jumper. Perhaps after a long period of duties the wish to want something for yourself is coming back. And perhaps you simply like it, which is a perfectly legitimate reason. If you do not want to show the feeling to anyone, a ring or a small detail can carry it. Sometimes it is enough that only you know.

I am afraid of red, or I cannot stand it. Why?

Sometimes it is **not red itself that bothers us** but everything **we carry with it**. Blood, prohibition, shouting, pressure or moments when we were far too exposed. And at other times you are simply tired and in the evening a crimson throw is shouting at you from the sofa. **You do not have to force yourself** into a red dress just because red is often linked with courage. The point is **to notice what it does to you** and to respect your own “yes” and “no”. And sometimes the best colour therapy is simply **to put that throw away in the wardrobe**.

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Ayurveda

Ayurveda is an old Indian teaching about health. It describes a person by three types of “energy”, the so-called doshas. Vata (air, restlessness), pitta (fire, intensity) and kapha (earth and water, heaviness). Colours are chosen to balance whatever there is too much of. Opposites are treated with opposites. Red belongs to fire; it is warm, active and stimulating. Some people come alive in it, to others it feels like one more voice in the room that they really did not need.

How this relates to the colour red. According to some sources, red is read in Ayurveda as the colour of fire and movement. **That is why it suits places where there is too much cold and heaviness, and fits less well where there is already enough fire.**

Pitta

This is how a woman who is purposeful, quick and thorough, and easily flares up, is described. Because pitta already belongs to fire, a strong red can heat it up even more. **Pitta does not need another match. Rather a little space around the fire.**

- **Red in moderation**
  Brick, coral or powder pink, only as an accent.
- **Add some cool**
  Blue, green and white. A white shirt and one red scarf instead of a whole red outfit.

Vata

This is how a woman who is imaginative and quick, but restless and often cold, is described. With red the recommendations diverge. Sometimes the warmth heats pleasantly, at other times it is too sharp. **If the colour calms you, keep it. If it winds you up even more, take it away.**

- **Softer and deeper shades**
  A blanket, jumper or tablecloth.
- **Evening and sleep**
  For the bedroom rather warm, muted shades and calmer light.

Kapha

This is how a woman who is calm, stable and patient, but sometimes does not feel like getting moving, is described. **Red can give her warmth, energy and a small “okay, let's go”.** Not because it magically lifts you off the sofa.

- **Add red**
  A scarf, a cushion, lipstick, tomatoes and peppers on the table.
- **Add movement**
  A walk, dancing, a brisker pace.

When you need a spark

Sometimes you do not feel like going out, being with people or doing anything. A red detail can work as **a small signal**. Today I will join in with life a little. You do not have to head out right away in a scarlet dress. Sometimes **a raspberry scarf**, red **earrings** or **lipstick** is enough.

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When you are already running at full speed

If you are rushing and everything irritates you, red **may not do you good**. In the language of Ayurveda you would say **turn down the heat**. Try a smaller area, a more muted shade, or swap red for blue or green for a while.

An online test cannot reliably determine your dosha. If you are more interested, consult a qualified Ayurvedic practitioner. A colour will tell you nothing about the state of your health. It is not treatment.

A Jungian view

Carl Gustav Jung, the Swiss psychiatrist, understood colours as symbols with two layers. **Personal** – that is, what we have experienced with a particular colour – and wider, culturally repeated images that return across eras and stories. In other words. Red can have a shared cultural tinge, but your own experience still has the last word.

- With him red is linked with blood, fire, passion and love. In one lecture he assigns it to feeling, that is, to how we evaluate experiences with the heart.
- It is often read as the colour of instinct, emotion and action, that is, of what happens before we have time to think it through.
- In alchemy, to which Jung referred a great deal, red is the final stage of transformation. It is read as completion.

What matters is that Jung **did not want to turn colours into a dictionary** of the “red means X” kind. The same red can be love for one woman, danger for another and a memory of grandmother's handbag for a third. So we always return to the question. What does it mean **for you**? A symbol without a personal story is only half a sentence.

Ask yourself

“What do I refuse to feel or show in myself?”

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Feng shui

In feng shui red belongs to fire – that is, to warmth, activity, visibility and yang energy. Its counterpart is yin, which is linked more with calm and rest.

Fire is traditionally tied to summer, noon and the south. On the bagua map the southern part of a space is linked with fame, recognition and how visible we are to the outside world.

And red has yet another layer in Chinese culture. It is the colour of **luck**, **celebration** and **good beginnings**. That is why we find it at weddings, at New Year and on red envelopes with money.

So yes – one colour can handle a wedding, success and a proper dose of attention.

Red is like chilli

> A little wakes the appetite, but a whole bag ruins your dinner.

In feng shui red therefore often works best as **an accent**. A cushion, a painting, a vase, a scarf or a detail on a textile can give a space a spark. A whole red wall, a red carpet and red curtains all at once can feel more like a room that refuses to lower its voice.

Especially in a space where you want to rest, this holds.

Red yes, but **it does not have to shout** from all four walls.

Simple tips

- **Want more energy?**
  Add one striking red element.
- **Want more calm?**
  Choose brick, wine, rusty or red only in a detail.
- **Is it already too much?**
  Add wood, linen, cream, brown, muted green or more empty space.
- **Want more courage?**
  Start with a small red detail that you carry with you. A scarf, a bracelet or a pouch in your bag.

And above all. Before you repaint the whole room, try a throw, a fabric or a larger colour sample. It is cheaper than a third round of painting and far fewer swear words.

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What people say and what holds true

MYTH Red makes a bull furious.

TRUTH Bulls do not distinguish red the way we do. What enrages them is the movement of the cloth, not its colour. The red muleta is more tradition than biology.

MYTH Red brings luck and love.

TRUTH In the Chinese tradition red is the colour of celebration and luck, but in feng shui the amount is watched. A large red surface in a bedroom can unsettle more than calm. Schools differ on this.

MYTH Red is always aggressive.

TRUTH It depends on the shade and the area. Brick, wine or poppy tones feel earthy and warm. One red detail is a good start, a whole wall calls for some thought.

Fire is not just red

In feng shui fire is not recognised by colour alone. It also includes **light**, **flame**, **sun**, sharp and **triangular shapes**.

So a room can be “fiery” even without a single red wall.

A striking lamp, harsh light, geometric patterns and a few strong colours already do their part. If you long for calm in the evening, a new cushion sometimes does not help. Sometimes it is easier to turn off the lamp that shines like an interrogation.

What red goes well with

- **Cream, linen, cotton, light wood**
  Red stands out, but enough calm remains around it.
- **Terracotta, clay and brown**
  More warmth, less drama. Red softens and feels more earthy.
- **Muted green and plants**
  Next to brick or wine it looks natural. Just watch out for sharp green and sharp red side by side – that can become visual ping-pong.
- **Black and metal**
  They give red drama and elegance. Great for one striking corner. Less great if you want the whole room to whisper “rest”.

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Elements

In feng shui the elements are related to one another.

- **Wood feeds fire**
  A plant and a red picture can feel alive and growing.
- **Fire creates earth**
  Terracotta, clay and brown tones calm and ground red.
- **Water dampens fire**
  Symbolically this includes black and very dark blue.
- **Fire acts on metal**
  Red with brass can feel festive, with grey more restrained.

Take it as a **traditional image** of the relations between elements, **not as a ban** on combining two colours in one room.

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Feng shui room by room

What works – what to watch for – a simple tip.

Living room

What works. A red cushion, blanket, vase or picture. Even **one stronger wall** is fine if the rest of the space stays calmer.

What to watch for. A red sofa, red curtains and a red carpet all at once can make the room seem **to want something all the time**.

I am not saying the sofa is to blame for the quarrel. But if nobody at home can slow down, it is worth looking around you too.

A simple tip. One striking piece and let the rest breathe. Wood, linen and matt surfaces calm red nicely.

Kitchen and dining room

What works. Red ceramics, napkins, one chair, a terracotta tile or a small accent.

What to watch for. The kitchen already has its fire – the hob and the oven. If you add red walls, a glossy red worktop and harsh light, you are figuratively putting more logs on.

A simple tip. Put red where you want **liveliness** and **a social atmosphere**, but keep large areas calmer.

Bedroom

What works. Muted red, **wine**, **brick** or a smaller accent in textiles. A cushion, blanket, pyjamas, nightdress or a small picture.

What to watch for. A bedroom is for **sleep** and **closeness**. But when red is on the walls, curtains and carpet, and chaos all around on top of that, your head works a double shift.

Red and clutter together can work like **two alarm clocks at once**.

A simple tip. Keep red near the body or in one detail and keep large areas calmer.

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Children's room

What works. Red on toys, a cushion, a small rug or small accessories.

What to watch for. A child usually has enough energy without help from the interior. If the whole room is striking and the child cannot wind down in the evening, it may be good to take some of the red away.

We really do not need to turn an ordinarily lively child into a monkey on an elastic band 24/7.

A simple tip. Large areas calm, strong colours rather in things that can be moved.

Study and studio

What works. In a studio a red picture or detail can bring courage and energy.

What to watch for. If you read, calculate or work at a computer for several hours, **a large red area** right in front of your eyes can be more of a distraction.

A simple tip. Red **next to the workspace** yes. The whole room in a state of “DEADLINE!” is not necessary.

Hallway and bathroom

What works. In the hallway a smaller red picture or a brick-coloured bench. In the bathroom a wine-coloured towel, terracotta ceramics or a red bath mat.

What to watch for. A narrow dark corridor can take less red than a light open space.

A simple tip. Ask yourself. Does the space **welcome me**, or does something **shout** at me right after I arrive?

A question for you

“Where does it do you good and where does it already disturb you?”

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Colour frequency and phototherapy

Perhaps you have already seen light masks for the face, panels or caps meant for the scalp. But here we leave the symbolism of colours and enter the world of **photobiomodulation** – that is, the use of certain wavelengths of light to influence some processes in cells and tissues.

And this is exactly where it is good to leave **miracle promises** at the door. Red light is **not a magic torch for everything**. It has specific areas where it is studied and used, and also areas where marketing runs faster than the evidence.

How light meets a cell

During treatment **red** or nearby **infrared light** falls on the tissue. Part of the light is absorbed and may influence processes inside cells – for example cell activity, inflammatory processes or tissue renewal.

One of the main lines of research is related to mitochondria, the parts of cells that take part in producing energy.

But that does not mean you sit under a lamp for ten minutes and get up like a phone charged to **one hundred percent**.

> Cellular energy and the feeling of “I have strength for the whole world again” are not the same thing.

Red light we can see normally. Near-infrared the human eye can no longer see. Some devices use both ranges, because they differ in how deep into tissue they penetrate and what they are used for.

Where red light is really used

Skin

In dermatology red light is used as a supplement to care for, for example, **fine lines** and **skin texture**. Its influence on collagen production is also studied.

Results are not the same for every person or every device. For acne, light therapy may also be used, sometimes in combination with blue light.

So yes, a light mask **may make sense**. Just do not expect it to bring back the face from your school-leaving photo after three evenings.

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Hair

For some types of hereditary and hormone-related hair thinning **there are studies** in which suitably set light devices supported hair growth and density.

Results are, however, evaluated gradually, more in months than in days.

And because hair loss can have many causes, light is not a universal answer for every handful of hair in the brush.

Professional medical care

Photobiomodulation is also used in **healthcare**. In some oncology treatments it is used, for example, to prevent or ease painful damage to the lining of the mouth during certain anticancer treatment.

This is no longer a home lamp from the internet, but a **precisely set** medical procedure carried out under the guidance of **a professional team**.

And importantly. **It does not treat the tumour itself**. It helps with a specific side effect of treatment.

What to expect from it – and what is too much

Photobiomodulation may make sense as **a complementary method** for a specific problem – for example some signs of ageing skin, certain types of hair thinning or a precisely defined medical use.

What, on the other hand, should you **not expect** from it?

That one red lamp will

- rejuvenate the whole body
- resolve chronic tiredness
- fix your mental health
- remove all pain
- and improve your relationship in the evening as well.

This is not about the symbolism of red. Here wavelength, power, dose, time and the specific use decide.

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Astrotype and colours

Astrotype is **a much wider topic** than just the Sun sign. If you really want to go deep, knowing only your date of birth is not enough. The exact place and time of birth matter too, because only from them are the ascendant, the positions of the Moon, planets and other parts of the horoscope calculated. Here, however, we really stay only on the edge of what is related to colours.

We do not deal with whole character, relationships, life path or the future. We only look at how the astrological symbolism of the individual signs may relate to **what kind of red** may be **pleasant**, what it may **support**, when it may become **too strong** and what to **balance** it with in colour. Take it as a small colour excerpt from a much deeper topic.

The ascendant is the sign that was rising on the eastern horizon at the moment of your birth. According to astrological tradition it shows how you come across outwardly and how you enter the world, while the Sun sign describes more who you are inside. For each sign you will therefore find not only its character but also a short note on how the colour fits when it is your ascendant.

Aries (21 March – 19 April)

Your red

Bright crimson · scarlet · warm red

Colours that do not ask much and walk straight into the room.

In astrology Aries is linked with **Mars**, fire and beginnings. That is why red is one of its most natural colours – it symbolises action, courage, impulse and the wish to get something going.

What Aries is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality cardinal · ruler Mars

Aries opens the zodiac and you can tell that it is first. It is a **pioneer** who gets into things before thinking them through perfectly. It is direct, impatient and likes to compete. It gets angry quickly but forgives quickly too.

Its strength is the **courage** to begin. Weaker is perseverance in long, slow matters. It does best where something is happening and where it can act at once.

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What it can support in you

Red can **support the feeling** of **“I am going for it.”**

It can suit you at a moment when you need to take **a first step**, say something out loud, make a decision or stop hiding behind endless thinking.

With Aries the strength lies in the fact that it does not stay long in one place.

Shadow impatience and abruptness

In the shadow, speed stops paying off. Courage turns into rashness, directness into sharpness, and energy runs out because it does not give itself time to recharge.

What is an advantage may also be a weakness.

When you are already going fast, red symbolically **adds more gas**. It can support impatience, sharper reactions or the need to settle everything at once.

A typical Aries moment? “I have already done it.” “Did you think it through?” “No. But it's done.”

The colour can also help you here. It helps you decide and begin, especially when you get stuck in thinking. It works as **a starter**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Red goes with colours that bring a little more **space** and **coolness**.

Blue · white · soft green

Not because they would “heal” you, but because they visually pull back the intensity.

Aries as ascendant

When Aries is your ascendant, you come across as direct, lively and decisive. People may see you as someone who gets straight to the point, and the first impression tends to be brisk.

Red with an Aries ascendant strengthens that brisk first impression. If you want to come across as calmer, leave it to a small detail, such as lipstick or a scarf.

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In everyday life

*Keep red for moments when you need **courage** and **forward drive**.*

When you feel on the contrary that you are going too fast, you can choose a smaller detail instead of a large area.

Red may remind you.

*Courage is not only setting off. Sometimes courage is also **waiting a moment**.*

Taurus (20 April – 20 May)

Your red

Wine · burgundy · brick · garnet

A red that has depth, warmth, and that you can almost touch.

Taurus is an **earth sign** linked with Venus, the senses, pleasure and stability. That is why red often suits it when it is not sharp but dense and pleasant.

What Taurus is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality fixed · ruler Venus

Taurus is an earthy, **patient** and sensual sign. It likes good food, pleasant materials, nature and security. It gets going slowly, but once it decides on something, it persists.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to enjoy the present moment. The weaker side tends to be stubbornness and finding it hard to let go of what is familiar.

What it can support in you

Red can support **sensuality**, **the wish to enjoy the moment**, **contact with the body** and a feeling of warmth.

With Taurus it is often not only about the colour itself. The material matters too.

Wine-coloured velvet, a soft blanket or a deep red on ceramics can feel completely different from glossy red plastic.

Taurus usually does not want a colour only to look good.

It wants it to be pleasant to live with too.

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Shadow stubbornness and clinging

In the shadow, comfort turns into fear of change. Taurus holds on to what it knows even when it no longer serves, and freezes.

Taurus likes **certainty**. And sometimes it likes it so much that it does not want to let go of anything it already knows.

Colours that are too heavy, dark and dense may further support a feeling of **stagnation** or **withdrawal**.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you return to the body and to **pleasure**, for example through food, fabrics or a candle.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Deep red **goes with**.

Green · cream · pink · light wood

They add more lightness and freshness.

Taurus as ascendant

When Taurus is your ascendant, you come across as calm, stable and pleasant. You build trust slowly and people often feel firm ground in you.

Deep wine or brick red suits it and adds warmth without noise.

In everyday life

*Red may remind you that pleasure **is not a reward for performance**.*

You can enjoy something without having first earned it with three completed tasks.

Gemini (21 May – 20 June)

Your red

Coral · orange-red · bright small accents

A colour that is playful and does not stay long in one place.

Gemini is associated with Mercury, **movement**, **communication** and **curiosity**.

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What Gemini is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Gemini is **curious**, talkative and adaptable. It learns quickly, likes to tell stories and enjoys it when a lot is going on around it. It can see several sides of one thing.

Its strength is **lightness** and wit. The weaker side tends to be scatteredness and a tendency to start more things than can be finished.

What it can support in you

Red can add **a spark**, **energy** and the wish to **talk**, **try things** and **react**.

When you are bored, it can wake you up quickly.

And Gemini really cannot be bored for long.

Shadow scatteredness and superficiality

In the shadow curiosity scatters. Gemini starts many things, talks about more than it experiences, and prefers to skip deeper feelings with lightness.

Gemini usually has enough stimuli even without help.

Too much strong red can add more stimulation to a head that already has fifteen tabs open, three of them playing music.

Then red can feel less like a spark and more like another notification.

The colour can also help you here. It helps get **energy** flowing and the wish to start talking or writing when boredom hits.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Works well.

Light blue · turquoise · white · grey

Gemini as ascendant

When Gemini is your ascendant, you come across as lively, friendly and chatty. People may see you as curious and youthful, even if inside you are perhaps calmer.

Red adds a few accents, but let them stay small, otherwise they will drown out your playfulness.

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In everyday life

With Gemini red can quite happily be changeable.

Lipstick one day, earrings another, nothing at all on a third.

You do not have to have one "own colour" forever. Gemini might get bored of that before it gets bored of the shade itself.

Cancer (21 June – 22 July)

Your red

Coral · salmon · dusty pink · muted brick

Cancer is a **water sign** linked with the Moon, home, closeness and sensitivity.

What Cancer is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality cardinal · ruler Moon

Cancer is **caring**, sensitive and strongly connected to home and family. It has a good memory for feelings and relationships. It enters the world cautiously, much like a crab with its shell.

Its strength is **empathy** and the ability to create safety. The weaker side tends to be changeable moods and a tendency to withdraw when it feels hurt.

What it can support in you

Red can add **warmth**, a feeling of **safety**, **closeness** and gentle **sensuality**.

With Cancer it does not need to say "Look at me." It can say **"Come closer."**

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Shadow withdrawing and oversensitivity

In the shadow Cancer closes up in its shell. It takes things personally, holds grudges and looks after everyone except itself.

A sharp, striking red can feel **too direct**.

When you are already sensitive, tired or overwhelmed, another strong stimulus may not be what you need.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you add **warmth** and the courage to speak up about your needs without having to raise your voice.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Suits.

White · silver · soft blue · pearl

Red stays warming but does not press.

Cancer as ascendant

When Cancer is your ascendant, you come across as gentle and careful. At first you keep your distance, but then warmth unfolds and people see in you someone who will look after them.

Soft coral or dusty pink lets people closer; a sharp red would, on the contrary, hide you behind a wall.

In everyday life

You can use red where you want to add warmth and a feeling of home.

But if you have a day when you would most like to crawl under a blanket and switch off the world, a red wall will probably ***not save*** *your mood.*

Leo (23 July – 22 August)

Your red

Crimson · royal red · red with gold

Leo is linked with the Sun, **creativity**, **joy** and **visibility**.

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What Leo is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality fixed · ruler Sun

Leo is **generous**, proud and creative. It likes to give, likes to rejoice and needs others to see and appreciate it. It is loyal and has a big heart.

Its strength is **warmth** and the ability to inspire others. The weaker side tends to be sensitivity to criticism and a tendency to want to be the centre of attention.

What it can support in you

Red can support **self-expression**, **the courage to show yourself** and the wish to **shine**.

Leo often does not need permission to be seen.

Red only reminds it that it may be seen a little more still.

Shadow need for admiration and pride

In the shadow Leo depends on how others see it. Pride turns into arrogance, generosity into ostentation, and criticism hurts more than it should.

There is a difference between "I am visible." and "**Everybody look over here now**."

Combinations that are too striking can feel ostentatious or dominant.

Red + gold + shine + a dramatic cut can be wonderful.

Or a coronation.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you show yourself, take **joy** in being seen and regain your confidence.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Works well.

- Cream
- white
- beige
- muted blue

Leo as ascendant

When Leo is your ascendant, you come across as self-assured, warm and striking. You enter a room in a way that people notice you even when you do not want them to.

Red adds shine to this; just take care that it does not look like a costume.

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In everyday life

Red may remind Leo.

*Being seen is not the same as **proving your worth**.*

Sometimes it is enough to walk into the room, and you do not have to bring an orchestra as well.

Virgo (23 August – 22 September)

Your red

Brick · wine · rust · muted red

Virgo is an **earth sign** linked with Mercury, detail, practicality and order.

What Virgo is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Virgo is **meticulous**, attentive and practical. It notices details that others overlook and likes to be useful. It tends to be modest and judges itself more strictly than others.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to improve things. The weaker side tends to be perfectionism, worries and a tendency to criticise itself.

What it can support in you

Red can add **the courage to act**, more **spontaneity** and the wish to **begin** even before everything is perfectly prepared.

And that is sometimes exactly what Virgo needs.

Shadow harsh self-criticism and worry

In the shadow Virgo looks for what is wrong. Perfectionism and worries exhaust it, and it finds it hard to allow itself rest or a mistake.

A strong red can feel **chaotic**, too **loud** or **untidy**.

Virgo may feel like first **straightening out** the colour, **fixing** it and giving it **a system**.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you ease off perfectionism and take the first step even when not everything is **perfect** yet.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Suits well.

Beige · white · sage · muted blue

Virgo as ascendant

When Virgo is your ascendant, you come across as neat, restrained and reliable. People see you as observant and sensible, sometimes even overly reserved.

A muted brick or wine suits you better than a loud red.

In everyday life

Red may remind you.

Something can be good enough without one last correction.

Yes, really. Even if that corner is not perfectly straight.

Libra (23 September – 22 October)

Your red

Raspberry · pinkish red · wine · elegant muted tones

Libra is associated with Venus, **beauty**, **relationship** and **balance**.

What Libra is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality cardinal · ruler Venus

Libra longs for **harmony**, beauty and justice. It is diplomatic, sociable and has a feel for aesthetics. It lives best in relationships in which it does not feel alone.

Its strength is **tact** and the ability to see both sides. The weaker side tends to be hesitation and a tendency to avoid conflict even when it would help.

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What it can support in you

Red can add **decisiveness**, **passion** and the ability to say **“this is what I want”**.

Libra sometimes has a talent for seeing all sides at once. Red can help remind it that now and then one of them has to **actually be chosen**.

Shadow hesitation and avoiding conflict

In the shadow Libra postpones decisions so as not to hurt anyone. It adapts, stays silent and seeks peace at the price of its own stance.

A red that is too sharp can feel **confrontational** or **disturb the sense of harmony**.

When there is too much of it, Libra may feel that the room or clothing is no longer elegant but is having **an argument** with her.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **decide** and say clearly what you want.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Works well.

- Pink
- soft green
- white
- cream

Libra as ascendant

When Libra is your ascendant, you come across as elegant, pleasant and balanced. People like you for your tact, even if inside you take a long time to decide.

Red in elegant tones suits it; a sharp one would disturb the sense of harmony.

In everyday life

Red may remind Libra.

*Even your **clear** “**no**” can be beautiful.*

And it does not have to be put to a vote.

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Scorpio (23 October – 21 November)

Your red

Garnet · burgundy · dark red · almost black red

Scorpio is a water sign and in traditional astrology is also linked with **Mars**, intensity, depth and inner strength.

What Scorpio is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality fixed · ruler Mars, in the newer view also Pluto

Scorpio is **intense**, deep and loyal. It feels strongly, but does not always show it. It dislikes superficiality and likes to get to what is hidden.

Its strength is **determination** and the ability to transform. The weaker side tends to be distrust, jealousy and a need to keep things under control.

What it can support in you

Red can highlight **sensuality**, **courage**, **mystery** and **intensity**.

Scorpio's red **does not have to be loud**.

Often a more interesting shade is one that looks almost black until light falls on it.

Shadow distrust and control

In the shadow Scorpio is jealous, distrustful and keeps everything under control so as not to be hurt. It closes off and sometimes punishes with silence.

Colours that are too dark and heavy may further support **closedness, drama** or a feeling that everything must have a deep meaning.

And sometimes a red mug really is not a fateful symbol. It is just a mug.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you express the **strength** and passion that you otherwise keep under control.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Helps.

Grey · beige · cream · muted green

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Scorpio as ascendant

When Scorpio is your ascendant, you come across as focused, mysterious and strong. People sense the intensity of your gaze and often feel that you know more than you say.

Garnet and burgundy deepen that impression without shouting.

In everyday life

Red may remind Scorpio.

***Strength** does not have to be hidden all the time.*

Sometimes it is safe to show something even before you have it perfectly under control.

Sagittarius (22 November – 21 December)

Your red

Warm red · coral · orange-red

Sagittarius belongs to Jupiter, fire, **movement**, **freedom** and **discovery**.

What Sagittarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter

Sagittarius is **optimistic**, open and free-spirited. It loves travel, new experiences and the search for meaning. It speaks honestly, sometimes a little too directly.

Its strength is **enthusiasm** and faith in a good outcome. The weaker side tends to be impatience with detail and a tendency to promise more than can be managed.

What it can support in you

Red can add **the courage to set out**, **try something new** and cross your own **boundaries**.

It is a colour that goes well with its natural wish to move on.

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Shadow exaggeration and impatience

In the shadow Sagittarius promises more than it can deliver and runs away from commitments and details. Honesty can turn into harshness.

When you are already going fast, more red can symbolically add more speed.

The result may be **restlessness**, **jumping** between things or a feeling that you must manage absolutely everything.

Ideally by Wednesday.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you set off towards something new and keep your **enthusiasm** when it starts to flag.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Helps.

Blue · green · darker natural tones

Sagittarius as ascendant

When Sagittarius is your ascendant, you come across as open, jovial and adventurous. People see you as someone with a wide outlook and an appetite for discovery.

A warm red supports the impression of enthusiasm and the wish to set out.

In everyday life

Red may remind you.

***Direction** is sometimes more important than **speed**.*

You do not have to cover three continents today.

Capricorn (22 December – 19 January)

Your red

Wine · mahogany · rust · dark red

Capricorn is an **earth sign** linked with Saturn, structure, discipline and perseverance.

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What Capricorn is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality cardinal · ruler Saturn

Capricorn is **responsible**, goal-oriented and disciplined. It likes to build and is not afraid of a long road. It has a dry sense of humour and shows it only to those it trusts.

Its strength is **perseverance** and the ability to see things through. The weaker side tends to be strictness with itself, reserve and a tendency to put joy off until later.

What it can support in you

Red can add **warmth, spontaneity** and a little more willingness to let joy into life.

It does not have to be loud. Capricorn often appreciates a colour that looks solid, high-quality and lasting.

Shadow strictness and self-denial

In the shadow Capricorn works without a break and puts joy off. It is hard on itself and on others and may feel lonely.

Combinations that are too dark and heavy may further emphasise **seriousness, austerity** or the feeling that everything must have a purpose.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you lighten up and allow yourself **spontaneity** without feeling that you have to earn joy.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Helps.

- Cream
- warm white
- light green
- natural materials

Capricorn as ascendant

When Capricorn is your ascendant, you come across as serious, mature and reserved. People may see you as older than you are, and only later discover how funny you are.

Wine or mahogany adds a dignified warm note.

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In everyday life

Red may remind you.

You do not have to work for joy first.

And no, a spontaneous purchase of a wine-coloured jumper does not need a five-year plan.

Aquarius (20 January – 18 February)

Your red

Unexpected. Red with turquoise, violet, blue or another contrast.

Aquarius is linked with **independence**, **originality** and the need to go **its own way**.

What Aquarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality fixed · ruler Saturn, in the newer view also Uranus

Aquarius is **independent**, original and idealistic. It is interested in ideas, humanity and the future. It wants to go its own way and does not like adapting to expectations.

Its strength is **perspective** and the ability to come up with new things. The weaker side tends to be distance from feelings and a tendency to withdraw when there is too much closeness.

What it can support in you

Red can add the courage to **stand out from the line**, **experiment** and show something differently.

Aquarius often does not need the “right” red.

It needs a red that **nobody has expected yet**.

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Shadow distance and defiance

In the shadow Aquarius withdraws from feelings and uses independence as a defence. It can seem cold or do things differently just on principle.

A classic red can feel too **predictable** or **traditional**.

And sometimes the wish to be different can be so strong that originality turns into just another rule.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **stand out from the line** and dare to follow your own idea.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Works well.

- Turquoise
- electric blue
- grey
- violet

Aquarius as ascendant

When Aquarius is your ascendant, you come across as independent, a little unusual and friendly. People see you as an original personality who keeps their own space.

Red in an unexpected combination underlines your impression.

In everyday life

Red may remind you.

Originality does not have to mean doing everything the opposite way.

Sometimes red is simply pretty. And that is enough too.

Pisces (19 February – 20 March)

Your red

- Raspberry
- coral
- dusty pink
- sunset red

Pisces is a **water sign** linked with imagination, sensitivity and the inner world.

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What Pisces is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter, in the newer view also Neptune

Pisces is **empathic**, intuitive and dreamy. It picks up the moods around it and often has a rich imagination. It frequently has a bond with art, music and spirituality.

Its strength is **compassion** and creative fantasy. The weaker side tends to be merging with other people's feelings, escaping into dreams and difficulty setting boundaries.

What it can support in you

Red can add **warmth**, **grounding** and the wish to **actually do something** rather than only dream about it.

It can be a small anchor back to the body and to reality.

Shadow escape and merging

In the shadow Pisces escapes into dreaming or gets lost in other people's moods. It finds it harder to set boundaries and becomes exhausted easily.

A sharp scarlet can feel **harsh**, too direct or **disturbing**.

When your head is already full of impressions and emotions, another strong stimulus may not be pleasant.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you take root in the body and **make real** what you dream of.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Helps.

- Blue
- green
- lavender
- soft water shades

Pisces as ascendant

When Pisces is your ascendant, you come across as gentle, dreamy and adaptable. People like to project their wishes onto you and tend to be kind to you.

Dusty pink or coral suits it; a sharp scarlet would overpower the gentleness.

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In everyday life

Red may remind you.

A dream takes shape only at the moment you do something.

You do not have to change your whole life straight away.

FOR A DEEPER LOOK

Seasons

Red is the colour of fire, summer and ripe fruit. Poppies, strawberries, cherries, tomatoes. Aries, Leo and Sagittarius are fire signs. Ask yourself when you reach for red.

Time of day

Red is the colour of the red dawn and of the evening glow. In the morning some people welcome it as a starter, for others it is too loud. In the evening it can warm, and sometimes rev you up when you would rather slow down.

Years of life

Saturn returns to the place where it stood at your birth at roughly 27 to 31 years of age and again between 56 and 60. Astrology reads it as a time of re-evaluation and new order. In those years red may feel close to you, or on the contrary foreign. Both are natural.

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Colour for your website and business

Yes – but it depends where and why you use it.

On a customer red works mainly as a **colour of attention**, **energy**, **action** and **urgency**. It can say “Look here”, “this is important”, “now is the time to act”. That is why it is used well in advertising, on **buttons**, for **special offers**, **discounts** and **striking offers**.

By itself, though, it **does not attract money or customers** like a magnet. It can help **catch** attention and **highlight** an offer, but what still decides is mainly **what you sell**, **to whom** and **how well** it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Red can say, for example

“Notice me.” “Something is happening here.” “This is important.” “Take action.”

- **Attention and urgency.** It is seen before other colours. It suits places where something should happen right now.
- **Energy and appetite.** It awakens appetite, movement and the wish to try something.
- **Courage and boldness.** A brand that wants to be seen and is not afraid to show it.
- **Passion and warmth.** In rich and brick shades it feels human and warm.

Depending on the shade, though, it can also feel different. A bright red is **more active** and **louder**, wine red feels **deeper** and **more elegant**, brick warmer and more human, coral friendlier.

Simple tips

Use it as an accent

A button, a price, a heading or one striking element is often enough.

Do not put it everywhere

When everything is red, nothing is important any more.

Shade by brand

Bright red for action, wine for elegance, brick for warmth, coral for friendliness.

Test it on the real website

Not just as a colour swatch. What looks good on its own can feel completely different on a page.

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Professions where it is a Yes

Gastronomy, street food and bakeries

Red highlights taste, pace and appetite well. Try it on packaging, a sign or one striking element. For a quiet café where guests want to sit for a while, I would choose brick or wine rather than a glaring red.

Sport, dance and events

Red can invite people to movement, a meeting and a quick decision. Give it a clear task on the poster. One date, one “sign up” button or one title. If you highlight everything, the organiser will be loud even on paper.

Fashion, creative projects and a personal brand

For a woman who wants to be seen, red may feel natural. Choose the shade according to the nature of the work. Wine feels elegant, coral friendly, brick warm. Let the work itself stand out, not just the colour.

Discounts, offers and calls to action

Red has proved itself on buttons, prices and time-limited offers, because it says “now”. But it works only when there is room left around it. A red page with no rest is more likely to tire the customer.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Wellness, therapy and meditation.** You are selling calm, quiet and safety. A rich red can go against the intended impression. A subtle detail or a muted shade may work better.
- **Sensitive counselling, grief and crisis help.** A woman often arrives tired or vulnerable. An urgent colour can feel like pressure.
- **Finance and law with an emphasis on discretion.** Quiet elegance and trust are carried better in calm tones. Red can stay in a small accent.
- **A place where red already means prohibition or warning.** More red decoration can visually drown an important signal.

Give important information clearly legible dark text.

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Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer, and ask “What would you expect from such a place or service?” **Is the offer visible, or mainly the red?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that red means energy and passion.

A question for you

“What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?”

Examples from the market

You know red from shops, adverts and the street. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

- **Coca-Cola (drinks)**
  Red, white lettering and a logotype you recognise even without reading it. The colour says: energy, taste, joy. It is often said that Coca-Cola invented the red Santa Claus. That is not true; he had a red coat before its adverts. Those from the 1930s, however, helped popularise him and tied red to Christmas as well.

- **Ferrari (cars)**
  “Rosso corsa”, racing red, was originally the colour of Italian racing cars. Today we associate it with speed, passion and prestige, and most Ferraris sold are in fact red.

- **Netflix and YouTube (video streaming)**
  The red logo and the play button say: press it, watch it, something interesting is going on. Here red works as an action button.

- **Christian Louboutin (footwear)**
  He first used the red sole around 1992 or 1993, when he borrowed red nail polish from an assistant. The colour of the sole is Pantone 18-1663 TPX. In 2012 a US court confirmed the brand's exclusive right to the red sole on shoes with an otherwise differently coloured upper.

What they have in common is that red carries a simple message. **Attention, taste, now**. And it is mostly not everywhere, only where it is meant to stand out.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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Different colour combinations

Red + orange

How it feels

Warm, lively, playful. Red loses some of its sharpness and orange adds sunshine and lightness.

When it suits

When you want **energy without too much pressure**.

Specific shades


scarlet + tangerine
lively and sunny


brick + apricot
soft and earthy


wine + rust
deep and warm


crimson + pumpkin
deeper and autumnal


coral + peach
gentle and playful

In practice

An orange cushion on a **red sofa**, a red scarf with a rust jumper.

Red + yellow

How it feels

Striking, **optimistic**, very **energetic**. It is a very loud pair.

When it suits

Where you want **joy**, **movement** and **attention**.

Specific shades


bright red + lemon
loud


brick + mustard
autumnal


wine + golden
festive


scarlet + sunshine yellow
joyful


wine + butter
soft

In practice

Red mugs and a **mustard tablecloth**, a wine-coloured dress with gold accessories.

Watch out

Bright red + bright yellow can quickly recall **fast food** or **warning graphics**.

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Red + green

How it feels

Contrasting and lively. These colours strongly emphasise each other side by side.

When it suits

When you want to join **warmth** with a **natural feel**.

Specific shades


wine + olive
naturally


brick + sage
gentle and earthy


crimson + dark green
rich and elegant


scarlet + moss
woodland


coral + mint
fresh

In practice

Red flowers among **greenery**, a wine jumper with olive trousers.

Watch out

Bright red + bright green can feel **very sharp** and sometimes even **Christmassy**.

Red + blue

How it feels

More balanced. Red adds warmth, blue adds calm.

When it suits

When you want to **soften** red but **not lose its strength**.

Specific shades


scarlet + navy blue
classic


brick + denim
relaxed


wine + petrol
quietly striking


crimson + sky blue
light


wine + cobalt
bold

In practice

Blue jeans and a **red jumper**, a blue interior with one red picture.

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Red + indigo

How it feels

Deep, **calmer** and a little **mysterious**.

When it suits

When you want to take some of the **loudness** out of red and give it **gravity**.

Specific shades



wine + indigo
deep



crimson + dark blue-violet
mysterious



raspberry + indigo
bold



scarlet + dark indigo
serious

In practice

Indigo jeans and a **wine coat**, a dark blue room with a red detail.

Red + violet

How it feels

Sensual, **rich**, a little **dramatic**.

When it suits

When you want **depth and presence**.

Specific shades



wine + plum
rich



crimson + amethyst
dramatic



raspberry + lavender
playful and soft



coral + lilac
light

In practice

Wine and **plum** textiles, a raspberry top with a violet accessory.

Watch out

Dark shades of both colours **can feel heavy**.

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Red + pink

How it feels

Softer, **gentler** and **more feminine**.

When it suits

When you want to soften red but stay in the **same colour family**.

Specific shades


crimson + powder pink
soft


wine + dusty pink
romantic


red + coral
warm


scarlet + rich pink
bold


scarlet + pale pink
tender

In practice

Powder-pink walls and one **wine detail**, a pink jumper and a red handbag.

Red + grey

How it feels

Elegant, **calmer** and **modern**.

When it suits

When you want red to **stand out but not shout**.

Specific shades


scarlet + light grey
clean


wine + anthracite
elegant


brick + warm grey
calm


raspberry + pearl grey
gently modern


scarlet + silver
cool and shiny

In practice

A grey sofa and a **red cushion**, a grey dress and a wine handbag.

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Red + brown

How it feels

Warm, **earthy** and **natural**.

When it suits

When you want to **calm** red and give it a **feeling of home**.

Specific shades


brick + cognac
homely


wine + dark brown
solid


rust + beige-brown
natural


scarlet + caramel
sweet and warm


crimson + chocolate
deep

In practice

Wood and **brick-coloured textiles**, brown boots and a wine coat.

Red + white

How it feels

Clean, **bright** and **striking**.

When it suits

When you want to give red space and highlight it **without other colours**.

Specific shades


scarlet + pure white
bright


wine + cream
soft


brick + ivory
warm


raspberry + milky white
light

In practice

A white shirt and a **red skirt**, a light interior with one red piece.

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Red + black

How it feels

Strong, **dramatic** and **self-assured**.

When it suits

When you want **elegance**, **contrast** and **presence**.

Specific shades


crimson + black
dramatic


wine + ink black
elegant


bright red + matt black
modern


scarlet + charcoal
strong

In practice

A black dress and **red lipstick**, black furniture with a wine detail.

Watch out

On a large surface the combination can feel **heavy or aggressive**.

Red + gold

How it feels

Celebration and fire. Red makes gold glow and gold gives red shine. Together they feel festive and striking.

When it suits

When you want **celebration and courage**.

Specific shades


red + gold
festive


wine + antique gold
striking


coral + champagne
dramatic


scarlet + rich gold
warm


brick + matt gold
subdued

In practice

A red dress and gold jewellery. A red wall and a gold frame.

Watch out

Two strong colours tend to be loud. Add **black or cream**.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to soften red, add **white**, **grey**, **cream** or **pink**.
- When you want to ground it, add **brown**, **brick**, **olive** or **natural materials**.
- When you want to make it stand out, add **black**, **green** or **yellow**.
- When you want to cool it, **blue**, **indigo** or **turquoise** will help.

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